Rival offers brief: mobile plans

Prepared for a hypothetical mid-size US mobile operator. Reviewed by a designated analyst before it reaches the client.

Sample only. The rival offers below are real, taken from the rivals' public pages on 9 Nov 2026. Everything about the operator is made up for this example.

What changed this week

RIVAL	OFFER	PRICE NOW	BEFORE	SOURCE
AT&T	Extra 2.0, 4 lines	**$35** per line a month	$50	att.com/plans/wireless, 9 Nov 2026
T-Mobile	T-Mix More, 3 lines	**$51.67** per line a month	$61.67	t-mobile.com/cell-phone-plans, 9 Nov 2026
T-Mobile	T-Mix Standard, 4 lines	**$25** per line a month	$33.33	t-mobile.com/cell-phone-plans, 9 Nov 2026

AT&T's Extra 2.0 is a like-for-like match for the operator's Unlimited Plus plan. T-Mix Standard is a lower tier and is not like-for-like. T-Mix More is worked out from a 3-line price of $155 with AutoPay, divided by 3.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR THE OPERATOR

AT&T now sells a comparable 4-line plan at $35 a line against the operator's $40.

That is a gap of 12.5%, where there was none before the move. Multi-line families and couples are the groups most exposed. See the decision memo in part 2 for how a response is weighed.

WHAT WAS NOT CHECKED

- Offers shown only in store, by address or to existing customers.
- Whether the offers end on a date. The pages did not say.
- How many customers either rival is winning or losing. That is not public.

Where to place next year's $100 million

Draft decision memo for a hypothetical mid-size US mobile operator. Five thousand scenarios, fixed seed. Every input is illustrative.

RECOMMENDATION

Place $50 million in retail and dealers, $40 million in digital and $10 million in partner bundles.

It averages $84.5 million of contribution, against $80.4 million for the current 70 / 20 / 10 split. It beats the current split in 72% of the 5,000 scenarios. In the worst 10% of scenarios it returns $54.0 million, against $48.2 million.

WHERE MORE SPEND STOPS BEING WORTH IT

CHANNEL	SPEND BEYOND WHICH MORE IS NOT WORTH IT	80% RANGE
Retail and dealers	$54 million	27 to over 100
Digital	$40 million	21 to 76
Partner bundles	$13 million	6 to 29

KEY UNCERTAINTY

The answer depends most on the sales expected from retail and dealers. At the low or high end of its range, the best split moves by up to 21 points of the budget.

NEXT ACTION

Replace the sales and margin numbers with activations by channel against commission and campaign spend, then run it again. Move part of the budget first and measure it.

WHERE AN ANALYST STEPS IN

- Whether the returns measured last year will hold next year.
- Which stopping points are real limits, such as capacity or contracts.
- Whether to shift part of the budget first, as a test.

ASSUMPTIONS AND LIMITS

- Sales, margin and how quickly returns fade are inputs and assumptions, shown as ranges.
- Each channel is an independent curve, so this is the best split inside the model, not a forecast.
- Rivals' spend was not read.

Workflow summary

How a recurring question is set up and run. The example is the rival offers brief in part 1.

Question	What are our main rivals offering on mobile plans, and should we respond?
Rivals	AT&T and T-Mobile (up to 3 on the Monitor programme)
Sources	Each rival's public plans page, captured with its address and date
Schedule	Every week, with a brief on the first working day
Review	A designated analyst reviews every brief before it reaches you
Delivery	By email, with the memo if a decision is due

HOW EACH RUN WORKS

1. **Collect.** The workflow reads each page as a visitor would see it, and records the offer, its conditions and where it came from.
2. **Check.** It compares today's capture with the last one, and flags anything it could not read.
3. **Analyse.** It works out the price gap, what changed and who it affects, using rules you can see.
4. **Draft.** It writes the brief, and a decision memo if the change is large enough to need a decision.
5. **Review.** The analyst checks the sources, tests the reading and rewrites anything unclear.
6. **Deliver.** You receive the brief, and the analyst is there for questions.

WHAT STAYS WITH YOU, AND WHAT WE HOLD

- Your data stays under your control. We agree in writing where it is processed, who can see it and how long we keep it.
- Most of this work uses public sources about companies. Nothing here is a claim about a real client.